SPOKES

Strategic Planning in Occupational Knowledge for Employment and Success

Skills for Life

TIME ARCHITECT

Time Management

Maximizing Productivity & Achieving Goals

Teacher's Guide

Instructor speaking notes, discussion prompts, linked resources, and class-prep checklist.

WIPPEA Lesson Format

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Strategic Planning in Occupational Knowledge for Employment and Success

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Printable Resources Checklist -- See the final page

W CHAPTER 1: WARM-UP

WARM-UP

SLIDE 1 -- Time Management

Speaking Notes:

Say: Welcome to Time Management. Today is not about packing more work into an already full day. It is about deciding what deserves your time and building habits that make work, school, and home easier to manage.

Do: Point out the lesson resources and tell students they will practice with real tools, not just talk about them.

HANDOUT Time Management Lesson Plan

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

SLIDE 2 -- Self-Reflection

Speaking Notes:

Say: Before we talk about strategies, let's get honest about what is working and what is not. This self-reflection is for you. It is not graded.

Do: Give students time to complete the self-assessment. If using the online version, remind them they do not need to create an account.

Ask: What is one time management habit you already do well? What is one habit you want to improve?

HANDOUT Time Management Self-Assessment

I CHAPTER 2: MODULE OBJECTIVE

INTRODUCTION

SLIDE 3 -- Module Objective

Section Title

Speaking Notes:

Say: This lesson has one practical goal: help you use your time with more purpose. We will look at priorities, planning tools, common distractions, and ways to follow through.

Ask: When you hear 'time management,' what comes to mind first: calendars, stress, deadlines, family, work, or something else?

> **DISCUSSION PROMPT**
>
> *Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?*

SLIDE 4 -- We All Have 24 Hours

Speaking Notes:

Say: Everyone gets 24 hours, but not everyone has the same responsibilities. Some people are balancing work, kids, transportation, health, school, and money pressure all at once.

Ask: What makes time management harder in real life than it looks on paper?

SLIDE 5 -- The goal of effective time management is to maximize productivity and achieve your goal

Speaking Notes:

Say: The point is not to stay busy. Busy can still mean scattered. Productive means your time is moving you toward something that matters.

Ask: Think of a day when you were busy all day but did not feel like you accomplished much. What happened?

SLIDE 6 -- What You Will Be Able to Do

Speaking Notes:

Say: By the end of class, students should be able to explain why time management matters, name common barriers, sort tasks by urgency and importance, and use planning tools.

Do: Keep this slide brief. It is a roadmap, not a lecture.

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

P CHAPTER 3: SETTING PRIORITIES

PRESENTATION

SLIDE 7 -- Setting Priorities

Section Title

Speaking Notes:

Say: We are starting with priorities because a planner does not help much if we do not know what matters most.

Ask: What usually gets your attention first: the most important thing, the loudest thing, or the easiest thing?

SLIDE 8 -- What Are Priorities?

Speaking Notes:

Say: Priorities are the things that deserve attention first because they matter most. They help us decide what gets done now, what waits, and what may not need our time at all.

Ask: What are your top three priorities right now? They can be work, family, health, school, finances, or personal goals.

SLIDE 9 -- Watch: The Big Rocks of Time

Video

Speaking Notes:

Say: As you watch, pay attention to what goes into the jar first. The jar is your day. The big rocks are your most important responsibilities and goals.

Do: Play the video. Pause afterward before moving on.

Ask: What are examples of 'sand' that fill up a day before the important things get attention?

[VIDEO] The Big Rocks of Time

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: What stood out from the video? What is one idea you could use outside this classroom?

SLIDE 10 -- The Big Rocks of Time

Speaking Notes:

Say: If we let small tasks go first, the important things get squeezed out. Big rocks need space on purpose.

Do: Use the Big Rocks Worksheet. Have students name two or three big rocks and one thing that often crowds them out.

Ask: What is one big rock you need to protect this week?

HANDOUT	Big Rocks of Time Worksheet

SLIDE 11 -- You've identified your priorities...Now what?

Speaking Notes:

Say: Once priorities are clear, the next question is simple: how do we make time for them? The next section gives you tools you can use right away.

Do: Transition quickly into the tools section.

P CHAPTER 4: TOOLS & STRATEGIES

PRESENTATION

SLIDE 12 -- Tools & Strategies

Section Title

Speaking Notes:

Say: Tools do not manage time for us. They help us make better choices when life gets busy.

Ask: What tool do you already use to remember tasks: phone reminders, paper planner, sticky notes, calendar, or another system?

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

SLIDE 13 -- Set SMART Goals

Speaking Notes:

Say: A vague goal is easy to ignore. A SMART goal tells you exactly what you are doing, how you will measure it, and when it should happen.

Do: Give this quick example: 'I need a job' becomes 'I will submit three job applications by Friday at 3 p.m.'

Ask: Why is the second goal easier to act on?

SLIDE 14 -- Utilize a Flow Chart

Speaking Notes:

Say: A flow chart helps when you have too many tasks competing for attention. It slows the decision down just enough to ask, 'What should I do first?'

Do: Point students to the Priorities Flow Chart. Use one real example from the class and walk it through the chart.

HANDOUT Get Your Priorities Straight Flow Chart

SLIDE 15 -- The Eisenhower Matrix

Speaking Notes:

Say: The Eisenhower Matrix sorts tasks using two questions: Is it urgent? Is it important? Urgent means time-sensitive. Important means it connects to responsibilities, goals, or consequences.

Ask: Which quadrant do people often avoid even though it matters most? Guide students toward Schedule.

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

SLIDE 16 -- Match the Task to the Action

Speaking Notes:

Say: Now we will practice. The scenarios are separate from the answers on purpose. Pick one scenario, decide which classification fits, and explain your reasoning.

Do: Let the class vote before clicking. After each match, ask students to name the clue that helped them decide.

Ask: Was the clue urgency, importance, ability to delegate, or lack of value?

SLIDE 17 -- Daily & Weekly Planners

Speaking Notes:

Say: Planners work because they make time visible. If a priority is only in your head, it is easy for the day to push it aside.

Do: Have students fill in tomorrow's planner or choose one day this week to plan.

Ask: Where will your most important task fit?

HANDOUT Daily Planner; Weekly Planner

SLIDE 18 -- Family To-Do Lists & Delegation

Speaking Notes:

Say: Delegation is not dumping work on someone else. In a family or team, it means sharing responsibility so one person does not carry everything.

Ask: What is one task at home that someone else could learn to do with clear directions?

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

P CHAPTER 5: COMMON CHALLENGES

PRESENTATION

SLIDE 19 -- Common Challenges

Section Title

Speaking Notes:
Say: Even with good priorities and tools, challenges will show up. This section names the common ones so students can recognize them early.

Ask: Which challenge do you expect to see on the next few slides?

SLIDE 20 -- Time Management Dangers

Speaking Notes:
Say: These are common time management traps. As we open each one, think about whether it shows up at work, school, home, or all three.

Do: Click through the cards. After each card, ask for one real-life example.

SLIDE 21 -- Technology Distractions

Speaking Notes:
Say: Technology is useful, but it is also designed to interrupt us. Notifications, videos, and apps can take time before we notice it is gone.

Ask: What phone setting or app causes the most interruptions for you?

> **DISCUSSION PROMPT**
>
> *Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?*

SLIDE 22 -- Watch: How Smartphones Sabotage Your Brain's Ability to Focus

Video

Speaking Notes:
Say: Watch for one idea you could actually use this week. It does not need to be dramatic. A small change counts.

Do: Play the video, then pause for reactions.

Ask: What is one phone habit you could change during work, school, or family time?

[VIDEO] How Smartphones Sabotage Your Brain's Ability to Focus

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: What stood out from the video? What is one idea you could use outside this classroom?

SLIDE 23 -- Procrastination

Speaking Notes:

Say: Procrastination is not always laziness. Sometimes it is fear, confusion, boredom, or not knowing where to start.

Ask: What is one task people often put off because it feels too big or uncomfortable?

SLIDE 24 -- Watch: 3 Steps to Break the Procrastination Cycle

Video

Speaking Notes:

Say: As you watch, listen for one way to make a delayed task smaller and easier to start.

Do: Play the video.

Ask: What is the first tiny step someone could take on a task they have been avoiding?

[VIDEO] 3 Steps to Break the Procrastination Cycle

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: What stood out from the video? What is one idea you could use outside this classroom?

SLIDE 25 -- Multitasking

Speaking Notes:

Say: Multitasking feels productive, but switching between tasks costs focus. Many mistakes happen during the switch, not because people do not care.

Ask: Where could multitasking cause problems on the job?

SLIDE 26 -- Watch: What Multitasking Does to Your Brain

Video

Speaking Notes:

Say: Watch for what happens to the brain when it keeps switching tasks.

Do: Play the video.

Ask: What is one task that deserves your full attention instead of being mixed with other things?

[VIDEO] What Multitasking Does to Your Brain

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: What stood out from the video? What is one idea you could use outside this classroom?

SLIDE 27 -- Over-Commitment

Speaking Notes:

Say: Over-commitment happens when we say yes too quickly. A boundary is not rude. It is a way to protect time for what already matters.

Do: Practice this sentence together: 'I cannot commit to that right now, but thank you for asking.'

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

SLIDE 28 -- Lack of Structure & Routine

Speaking Notes:

Say: Structure reduces decision fatigue. A routine does not have to be perfect. It just gives your day a starting point.

Ask: What part of your day would benefit most from a routine: morning, meals, work time, homework, bedtime, or Sunday planning?

SLIDE 29 -- Watch: 10 Habits That Will Completely Change Your Life

Video

Speaking Notes:

Say: As you watch, listen for one habit that is realistic for your life right now.

Do: Play the video.

Ask: Which habit would make the biggest difference if you practiced it for two weeks?

[VIDEO] 10 Habits That Will Completely Change Your Life

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: What stood out from the video? What is one idea you could use outside this classroom?

SLIDE 30 -- What Would You Do?

Speaking Notes:

Say: Unexpected free time is easy to lose because it feels like extra time. This activity asks you to decide before the time disappears.

Do: Open each scenario and ask students what they would do first.

Ask: How can found time support your big rocks?

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

E CHAPTER 6: CHECK YOUR KNOWLEDGE

EVALUATION

SLIDE 31 -- Check Your Knowledge

Section Title

Speaking Notes:

Say: We are moving into review. This is a chance to check understanding, not to embarrass anyone.

Do: Encourage students to answer before discussing as a group.

SLIDE 32 -- Quick Check

Speaking Notes:

Say: Preparing for next week's interview is important, but it is not an emergency yet. That makes it a Schedule task.

Ask: What happens if the student waits until the night before? What changes about the quadrant?

SLIDE 33 -- Assessment Debrief

Speaking Notes:

Say: A score is only useful if it helps you choose a next step. Focus on one change, not ten.

Ask: What did your score reveal? What is one time habit you want to adjust this week?

HANDOUT Time Management Pre/Post Test; Time Management Rubric

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: What is one answer you feel confident about? What is one area where you want more practice?

SLIDE 34 -- Exit Ticket

Speaking Notes:

Say: The exit ticket helps students turn the lesson into a next action. Keep answers short and honest.

Do: Give students a few quiet minutes to write.

Ask: Who is willing to share one tool or habit they plan to try?

A CHAPTER 7: PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

APPLICATION

SLIDE 35 -- Put It Into Practice

Section Title

Speaking Notes:

Say: Application is where the lesson becomes useful. Students should leave with one action they can use outside this room.

Do: Set up the final sharing activity.

SLIDE 36 -- How Will You Put Your TIME to Use?

Speaking Notes:

Say: In this activity, everyone contributes. Keep responses short, clear, and practical.

Do: Use the round-robin process. If the class is large, split into smaller groups.

Ask: What is one idea from someone else that you may use?

DISCUSSION PROMPT

Ask: Where could this skill show up at work, school, home, or in a public situation?

SLIDE 37 -- Own Your Time

Speaking Notes:

Say: You will not control every demand on your time, but you can make more intentional choices. Start with one priority, one tool, and one habit.

Ask: In one word, how do you want to feel about your time after this week?

HANDOUT Time Management Rubric

Materials Checklist

Print Before Class

	Resource	Location
[ ]	Big Rocks of Time Worksheet	*Handouts*
[ ]	Daily Planner	*Handouts*
[ ]	Get Your Priorities Straight Flow Chart	*Handouts*
[ ]	Time Management Lesson Plan	*Handouts*
[ ]	Time Management Pre/Post Test	*Handouts*
[ ]	Time Management Rubric	*Handouts*
[ ]	Time Management Self-Assessment	*Handouts*
[ ]	Weekly Planner	*Handouts*

Note: All resources are available in the Handouts folder and linked in the presentation sidebar under Resources.